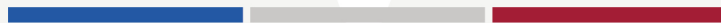




MIT SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
MIT SCHWARZMAN COLLEGE OF COMPUTING



MODULE 1 UNIT 1
Lesson Video 5 Transcript

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Swarm of agents frontier

PAUL MCDONAGH-SMITH: So, Kanch, we've talked about where Agentic AI is delivering value today. But, as we know, as we've discussed, every frontier has a leading edge. Potentialities today include agents that negotiate across systems, that maintain coherent plans over hours or days, that collaborate with other agents, that learn from their own kind of errors, their own mistakes in real time.

From where you sit, what do you see as kind of the genuine frontiers of Agentic AI right now? Those capabilities that are technically emerging, but not yet operationally mature. And which of these frontiers do you think our leaders listening to us here should be watching out for, watching most closely, even if they're not ready to bet on them yet?

KANCHANA PATLOLLA: So when I think about two years ago when we'd started thinking about agents, that came from a DeepMind paper which was released called Smallville, I think. It is a game. It's a gaming simulation. It's a bunch of, you know, it's a party organizing agents where one agent takes care of the hosting, one agent takes care of the event, one agent— so that is how it was. And it's a good paper actually if you could, it's just four or five pages. Yep. It talks about it. And this essentially, Demis actually talks about it more. His way of thinking is with gaming, and this was a gaming thing, which was introduced.

MCDONAGH-SMITH: Of course, that was his background, wasn't it?

PATLOLLA: That was his background and he's one of the most popular gamers as well. So when this, like, the era which we are now, particularly in the last few weeks which has come, is this swarm of agents. Which is particularly this specialized agents who understand the context well and can execute in their own abilities with the set of tools they are handed to and can perform the reasoning well. The interesting thing here is all of these abilities of agent already existed. The additional thing which is added is this, the ability to create this swarm of agents and the agents creating other agents and the autonomous piece of it. So these two things have had the ability with respect to what it can bring.

SPEAKER: Did you understand all the concepts covered in this video? If you'd like to review any of the content, please click on the chapter menu.